

Name: Mr. Min Thant Maung

Date of birth: 4th August, 1995

NRC: 12/AhSaNa(N)236691

Myanmar Address: Room 004, Building 25, Khayaypin street, Danyingone Housing, Insein township, Yangon division.

Thailand Address: Mae Sot, Tak Province, Thailand.

Dear Embassy of Japan in Thailand,

Good day to you.

My name is Min Thant Maung. I am a Burmese, Myanmar citizen. I was graduated with bachelor of electronics and communication engineering degree in 2019. And then I worked at Huawei Technologies company for 10 months, and at MYTEL (Telecom international Myanmar company) for 1 year.

In the first day of February 2021, military detained all elected leaders of the country and declared the coup so there were mass protests and demonstrations on the road of the whole country. I was participated in these mass protests against dictatorship to against military government and also participated in CDM Campaign (Civil disobedience movement), and incited to boycott military concerned companies to stop flowing money to dictator's military. And I educated people about the important of democracy, freedom, and civic education on social medias. I also resigned from MYTEL company which is owned by dictator's military to support CDM campaign. Since I resigned from company, I worked as a fitness trainer for my living at my owned gym which is opened at my apartment.

After all this happened, in 16th June, 2021, military soldiers and polices came to my apartment and arrested me by beating brutally. They sent me to military interrogation camp for a week and after interrogation finished, they sent me to Insein prison in 23rd June, 2021. They sued me with 505(A) political issue case and I was detained in the prison for four months until I was released in 20th October, 2021 by amnesty. Military government warned me not to keep doing things concerned with politics and I would be sentenced twice if I was arrested by political issues again.

I worked as a fitness trainer again at my owned gym after I was released. And in 7th February 2022, I got a job offer from DARAZ Myanmar of Alibaba group with project manager position. While I working at there, I got in touch with my friend Mr. Toru Kubota who is a Japanese living in Japan. He is a freelance documentary film maker and we knew each other in 2018 while I was working as a volunteer at an NGO called turning tables Myanmar.

He arrived to Yangon in 14th July 2022 and met me in 15th July, 2022. We worked together for his documentary film by interviewing former political prisoners including me, interviewing charity communities, filming rebel against dictatorship with punk rock music, and filming current situation of Myanmar under dictatorship. I worked for him as an interpreter when he communicated with local taxi drivers, civilians, and in some interview with Burmese people. Me and him also translated his videos in Burmese to English together.

In 29th July, 2022, he got in touch with a protester who is arranging flash protests in Yangon. Me and him interviewed this protester and after this, my friend was invited to come and film at a flash protest in South Dagon township. In 30th July 2022, me and him departed from his hotel. I went to my work and he went to South Dagon to film at flash protest. At this day on evening 6pm, my friend's hotel receptionist called me and told that my friend was arrested. Polices came and sealed his room not allowed to enter anyone. And polices take my information from my NRC ID which included my home address and others too. I was in panic station and moved to a safe house as soon as I knew.

At this time, polices sent my friend to military interrogation camp and trying to arrest the network of him. This is why I run away from Myanmar military government and now I am at Mae Sot, Thailand since 1st August, 2022 due to fear of my life. I can be arrested at any time for illegally residing in Mae sot District, Thailand. In addition, deportation to Myanmar could result in torture at any time, brutal killings and even long terms sentenced in prison. This is why I respectfully request for humanitarian assistance to Embassy of Japan in Thailand. Documentary photos of protests and working for documentary films are attached.

Please kindly review my application letter and feedback me ASAP. And feel free to reach out if you want to know more details.

Thank and Best Regards.

Mr. Min Thant Maung

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